

Tokyo with the family

Friday 25 to Sunday 27 September 2026. Fifteen of you, based in Ueno. Friday is old Tokyo on the doorstep, Saturday is built around the 12:00 teamLab Planets booking, Sunday is Harajuku and Shibuya with a sunset finish. Disney is deliberately left out.

DAY 1**Fri 25 Sept**

Ueno, Asakusa, Skytree

[Open day plan](#)**DAY 2****Sat 26 Sept**

teamLab Planets, Odaiba

[Open day plan](#)**DAY 3****Sun 27 Sept**

Meiji Jingu, Harajuku, Shibuya

[Open day plan](#)

Book now (three weeks out is already late for Tokyo)

- ☐ **Shibuya Sky, Sunday 27th, 17:00 entry.** Sunset is about 17:35 and Sunday sunset slots sell out first. [Book online](#). Small bags only, lockers provided, timed entry is strict.
- ☐ **Tokyo Skytree, Friday 25th, 17:00 timed ticket.** Cheaper booked ahead, and weekdays are cheaper than weekends. [Book online](#).
- ☐ **teamLab Planets, Saturday 26th, 12:00.** Already booked. Re-check the confirmation email and the arrival window. [Official site](#).
- ☐ **Dinner tables for 15, three nights.** Most Tokyo restaurants cap at 8 to 10, so book two adjacent tables or use the food halls listed on each day. [TableCheck](#), Tabelog, or ask the hotel to phone.
- ☐ **Optional: Warner Bros Studio Tour Tokyo (Harry Potter).** Only if the kids are fans; it replaces Sunday morning. Timed entry, roughly 6,300 to 7,300 yen adults, less for kids. [Book online](#).
- ☐ **Child IC cards.** Kids aged 6 to 11 pay half fare and need a child card, issued with passports at the [JR East Travel Service Center, Ueno station](#). Adults: Suica in Apple or Google Wallet.
- ☐ **Pack:** rain jackets (typhoon season), shorts or roll-up trousers for Planets, power banks, passports for the kids' cards.

Two things that have changed this year

Sumo. The September tournament runs 13 to 27 September at [Ryogoku Kokugikan](#), but all 15 days are sold out with no same-day sales; official resale via [Ticket Oosumo](#) is the only route. Free alternative on Friday: watch the top-division wrestlers arrive in kimono between about 13:30 and 15:00 (see Day 1 swap).

No pandas at Ueno Zoo. The last two left for China in January 2026. The zoo is still good value (kids free), just no queue for pandas. The Odaiba Unicorn Gundam statue also ended its display on 31 August 2026, so DiverCity is now just a mall.

BOOKING REFERENCES AND CONFIRMATION NUMBERS (type here, saves with the PDF)

DAY 1

Sunset 17:35

Friday 25 September

Ueno, Asakusa and Tokyo Skytree. Nearly everything is walkable or one short train.

Getting around today: start on foot from Ueno Park. Ueno to Asakusa is the Ginza line (5 min). Asakusa to Skytree is a 20 minute walk over the [Sumida River Walk](#) or one stop on the Tobu line. Home from Oshiage: Asakusa line to Asakusa, Ginza line to Ueno, about 20 minutes.

Time	Stop	Notes and links
09:00	National Museum of Nature and Science	Two minutes from the Ueno Park exit. Dinosaurs, the 360° theatre, the Japan Gallery. Adults about 630 yen, under-18s free. Allow 2.5 hours. Museum site .
09:30	Ueno Zoo (split option)	Send half the group here and meet for lunch. Adults 600 yen, kids free. Tigers, gorillas, polar bears, penguins, a petting area in the West Garden. Zoo site .
12:15	Ameyoko market	Street food for the brave. For 15 at tables use the Parco ya restaurant floor next to the station. Several halal-marked shops on the market street if anyone needs them.
14:15	Senso-ji	Kaminarimon gate, Nakamise snacks (melon pan, ningyo-yaki), incense, omikuji fortune slips for the kids. Kappabashi kitchen street is 10 minutes west for plastic-food fridge magnets.
15:30	Hanayashiki	Japan's oldest amusement park, tiny and retro, two minutes behind the temple. One hour is plenty. Entry about 1,200 yen plus rides, or a ride pass. Park site .
16:30	Walk to Skytree	20 minutes via the Sumida River Walk with the tower in front of you the whole way. Tobu line from Asakusa if legs are tired.
17:00	Tokyo Skytree	Pre-booked Tembo Deck at 350 m. Sunset about 17:35, then the city lights up. Book here .
18:15	Sumida Aquarium or Pokémon Center	Both inside Skytree Town. Aquarium: penguins and jellyfish, about an hour, open until 20:00 on Fridays. Pokémon Center is free and next to the Kirby Cafe.
19:15	Dinner, Tokyo Solamachi	Restaurant floors on 6F and 7F, and 30F to 31F with views. Big choice, but tables seat about 8, so split into two.

Swap: sumo arrivals instead of Hanayashiki. The Aki Bashi is on. Tickets are sold out, but on the 25th doors open at 10:30 and top-division bouts start around 14:00, so wrestlers walk in from Ryogoku station between about 13:30 and 15:00. From Ueno: Yamanote to Akihabara, Sobu line to [Ryogoku](#), 15 minutes. Then a 25 minute riverside walk north to Asakusa (or Oedo line to Kuramae, Asakusa line one stop). Free, and the kids will like the size of the wrestlers.

Wet weather: longer at the museum, then Skytree Town (aquarium, shops, Solamachi) has an afternoon in it. Skip Hanayashiki.

DAY 1 NOTES (type here, saves with the PDF)

DAY 2

Sunset 17:35

Saturday 26 September

teamLab Planets at 12:00, then Odaiba and the bay for sunset.

Getting there: leave Ueno at 10:15. JR Yamanote or Keihin-Tohoku to [Yurakucho](#) (8 min), Yurakucho line to Toyosu (8 min), Yurikamome one stop to [Shijo-mae](#). About 45 minutes door to door. Avoid the Toei bus from Tokyo station, it is chronically congested. Home: Yurikamome to [Shimbashi](#) (15 min), JR to Ueno (15 min).

Time	Stop	Notes and links
11:00	Toyosu Senkyaku Banrai	Early lunch, linked to Shijo-mae by walkway. Edo-style food hall: sushi, ramen, tempura, grilled seafood. Eating before noon beats both the lunch queue here and the entry queue next door. Site .
12:00	teamLab Planets TOKYO	Booked. Shorts or roll-up trousers (knee-deep water in one room), no long skirts (mirror floors). Lockers for shoes and bags. Expect 20 to 30 minutes queueing even with tickets. Allow 2.5 to 3 hours; the Athletics Forest and the catch-and-collect forest (download the app) hold kids for ages. Official site .
15:15	Yurikamome to Odaiba	Shijo-mae to Odaiba-kaihinkoen, about 10 minutes. Sit at the front of the driverless train, the kids will fight for it.
15:30	Decks Tokyo Beach	Tokyo Joypolis (Sega indoor park, check ride height limits) for the kids, Legoland Discovery Centre for any who are younger, the terrace with a bridge view for the adults. Decks site .
17:30	Odaiba beach and Rainbow Bridge	Sunset over the bay, then the bridge lights. Photo at the Statue of Liberty replica .
18:15	Dinner, Aqua City	5F Tokyo Ramen Kokugikan Mai : six ramen shops around communal seating, no booking needed for 15. Or the Decks restaurants facing the bridge. Aqua City site .
19:45	Home via Shimbashi	Yurikamome from Daiba, then JR to Ueno. About 40 minutes.

Alternative finish: the Tokyo Cruise water bus from [Odaiba Kaihin Koen pier](#) to Asakusa takes about 55 minutes past Rainbow Bridge and Skytree, then Ginza line from Asakusa to Ueno in 5 minutes. Check the timetable; the last sailings are late afternoon, so this means leaving Odaiba before sunset.

Wet weather: this day already works in the rain. Joypolis and Decks are indoors; the beach and bridge are the only casualties.

DAY 2 NOTES (type here, saves with the PDF)

DAY 3

Sunset 17:35

Sunday 27 September

Forest shrine first, then Harajuku, Nintendo, and a sunset over the crossing.

Getting there: JR Yamanote from [Ueno](#) to [Harajuku](#), about 30 minutes, leave by 08:40. Everything after that is on foot within Harajuku and Shibuya. Home: Yamanote from Shibuya to Ueno, about 35 minutes.

Time	Stop	Notes and links
09:15	Meiji Jingu	Forest approach, giant torii, the sake barrel wall, ema wishes. Free. Sunday mornings often have Shinto wedding processions. Shrine site .
10:45	Takeshita Street	Go before the Sunday crush. Crepes, rainbow candyfloss, Daiso for cheap souvenirs. Agree a meeting point at the far end; it is one narrow street.
11:45	Kiddy Land	Five floors of character goods on Omotesando, opens 11:00. Set a budget and a 30-minute limit. Each floor has its own till. Store site .
12:30	Miyashita Park	12 minute walk. Lunch at Shibuya Yokocho on the ground floor: many small stalls, easy to spread 15 people. Then the rooftop park and bouldering wall. Site .
14:30	Shibuya Parco	6F: Nintendo TOKYO, Pokémon Center Shibuya, Capcom Store, Jump Shop. Then Hachiko and the crossing, best watched from the Mag's Park rooftop at Shibuya 109. Parco site .
17:00	Shibuya Sky	Pre-booked. Open-air roof at 229 m over the crossing, sunset about 17:35. Small bags only, lockers provided, no tripods. Book here .
18:30	Dinner, Shibuya Scramble Square or Hikarie	Restaurant floors in both towers, directly above the station. Yamanote back to Ueno afterwards.

Swap: Harry Potter morning. Replace Meiji Jingu and Harajuku with the [Warner Bros Studio Tour Tokyo](#) at Toshimaen (about 45 minutes from Ueno via Ikebukuro on the Seibu line, or the Oedo line). Book the 09:30 slot, allow four hours, eat there, then Ikebukuro to Shibuya in 20 minutes for Parco and Shibuya Sky. [Tickets](#).

Backup or evening extra: [Akihabara](#) is two stops from Ueno. Sunday afternoons the main street is pedestrianised; arcades, crane games and gachapon halls for the kids.

DAY 3 NOTES (type here, saves with the PDF)

Practical

Moving fifteen people

Nominate a leader and a sweeper. Agree a meeting point and a time at every stop before anyone wanders. Split freely: the kids and the grandparents do not need the same pace, and two groups of seven or eight fit restaurants, lifts and train doors far more easily than one of fifteen. Keep a WhatsApp or LINE group with everyone's live location shared for the three days.

Trains, cards, taxis

Adults: Suica in Apple or Google Wallet, top up with a card. Kids aged 6 to 11 pay half fare and need a child IC card, issued with passports at the JR East Travel Service Center in Ueno station. Twelve-year-olds pay adult fare. Tap in and out at every gate; the kids' cards beep differently so staff can hear them. Taxis seat four, so fifteen people means four cabs; only worth it late at night. Trains beat a chartered minibus everywhere on this route.

Weather

Late September is 24 to 29°C, humid and showery, and still typhoon season. Each day page has a wet-weather line. The indoor anchors are the science museum, Sumida Aquarium, Skytree Town, Planets, Joypolis, Parco and the Shibuya food floors.

Eating with 15

Food halls and food courts are your friend: Solamachi, Senkyaku Banrai, the Aqua City ramen floor, Shibuya Yokocho, department store restaurant floors. Chains that take groups: Kura Sushi and Sushiro (book tables in the app), Gyu-Kaku yakiniku, Saizeriya. Convenience-store breakfasts are excellent and fast. Carry a small towel and hand sanitiser; many toilets have no paper towels.

Numbers

Police 110. Ambulance and fire 119. Japan Visitor Hotline (JNTO, 24 hours, English) 050-3816-2787. Pharmacies are marked with a green cross; most stations have a staffed office that will help with a lost card or child.

Daily checklist

- ☐ Confirmations downloaded to phones (Planets, Skytree, Shibuya Sky) and screenshots taken in case of no signal.
- ☐ Meeting points agreed for each day and shared in the group chat.
- ☐ Kids' IC cards topped up; each child has a card with the hotel address and an adult's number in a pocket.
- ☐ Rain jackets and a change of socks for Planets in the day bags.
- ☐ Restaurant tables booked for each evening, or a food hall chosen.

HOTEL ADDRESS, ROOM NUMBERS, AND WHO IS IN WHICH GROUP (type here, saves with the PDF)